

Preliminary Quality and Testing Considerations - Moodle Redesign

Project: Building an Editor Academy Moodle Platform (Team 74, OAPA)

Owner: Dev 2, Shaikh Zarin Tasnim

Sprint: Sprint 1

[Quick note: responsive/mobile and accessibility were already ticked off on the board before I got to this, so I'm skipping those and focusing on what's left, browser/device compatibility, navigation and content edge cases, interactive content testing, and being upfront about what still needs actual environment access to confirm. A bit of the interactive content stuff builds on something I looked into for a previous task, so I haven't repeated all the background, just the bits that actually matter for testing.]

How I went about this

We still don't have Moodle sandbox access so I couldn't actually click through anything myself, which is a bit annoying honestly since half of this stuff would take five minutes to check if I could just log in. Instead I went through the OAPA spec doc section by section, the four month course cycle, the async content, workshops, assessment, peer review, and tried to line each part up against what Moodle actually supports out of the box. I also read through a bunch of Moodle admin/support pages from different universities and a few old forum threads where people had already run into browser issues, since actual reported bugs tend to be more useful than the official docs which are pretty vague about edge cases. Anywhere the spec asks for something that isn't a standard Moodle feature (the two deadline thing, sequencing by completion instead of date) I've flagged it separately because those feel like the spots most likely to break in a weird way later.

Browser and device compatibility

Moodle technically works on any standards compliant browser, but pretty much every uni support page I found only actually tests and recommends Chrome, Firefox, Edge and Safari, latest versions. IE11 straight up isn't supported anymore on newer Moodle so that one's just off the table. A couple of old forum posts also mentioned Safari 7 and below having rendering problems but that's ancient at this point and probably not something OAPA's members would even be running.

Some things I think are worth flagging that aren't just "use a modern browser":

- Cookies and JavaScript need to be on for a lot of Moodle to actually work, might be worth a note somewhere for OAPA people since they're an open access/privacy minded crowd and some of them probably run locked down browser settings
- More than one source mentioned browser extensions and toolbars causing weird unexplained bugs that are basically impossible to diagnose remotely, good to keep in mind if a tutor reports something odd later and we can't reproduce it

- Safari apparently has known issues with some third party plugin integrations, Turnitin was the example that kept coming up, so whatever we end up using for submissions/plagiarism checking needs its own dedicated Safari test, not just a general once over
- Whatever video call tool gets picked for the live monthly workshops (spec section 5.3) is a separate thing bolted onto Moodle, so it needs its own browser check, Moodle working fine doesn't mean the embedded conferencing widget will
- The spec mentions OAPA's membership is probably spread out internationally, so it's not just about device type, connection speed matters too, especially for workshop recordings, Moodle's own guidance says roughly 5mbps as a rough minimum

Navigation and content edge cases

I basically tried to walk through the four month cycle from the spec and think about where things could go sideways for a learner:

- If someone skips around Month 1 instead of doing it in order, does the sequencing actually stop them getting into Month 2, or could they just bookmark/guess a URL and skip ahead anyway
- If someone completely misses the soft deadline, the spec says they should still be able to submit at the hard deadline no problem, so that needs to actually work and not accidentally lock the activity on them
- Someone submits at the soft deadline, gets feedback, but never bothers revising before the hard deadline, does it just grade what they already submitted or does something break because it was expecting a revision
- Starting a module on your laptop then picking it back up on your phone later, does progress actually carry over or does it look like you never started when you open it on the other device
- Trying to jump into the Month 4 assessment stuff before finishing Months 1 to 3, since the spec wants that gated by completion, not just by date
- Cohort enrolment vs someone just self enrolling individually, both are supposed to be supported, so need to check they both actually land the person in the same place with the same access, not two slightly different setups
- A tutor giving one specific learner an extension, does that only shift that person's deadline or does it mess with what the rest of the cohort sees on the shared calendar
- Short courses are allowed to use a shortened or reordered version of the four phase template per the spec, so worth checking the sequencing logic still holds up when phases are skipped or squashed together instead of run the normal way

Interactive content testing

This ties back into some interactive content stuff I looked at for a previous task, where H5P came out as the main option for self check activities and interactive video. From a testing angle specifically, here's what I think needs actual attention rather than a general glance over:

- Whether H5P self check activities actually save progress properly and show up in the overall course progress bar, not just inside the activity itself, these are apparently two separate tracking things in Moodle and they don't always line up automatically

- Interactive video question overlays working properly across all the browsers mentioned above, this kind of content tends to be the first thing that visibly breaks on an uncommon browser/OS combo since it leans on JavaScript a lot more than a plain Moodle page does
- Discussion forums on each module actually loading and letting people post from mobile browsers, not just desktop, given the spec expects people to be doing this async from wherever they happen to be
- Peer review anonymity settings (spec section 5.5 wants anonymous, double anonymous, and fully visible modes all configurable) actually showing the right identity state depending on how it's set up. This one probably deserves its own dedicated round of testing rather than getting lumped in with everything else, since getting anonymity wrong in a peer review context is a trust/privacy issue for real people, not just a UI glitch
- Workshop recordings once they're published back into the course, need to check playback works across browsers and that access permissions match the rest of the course, since a recording could have other learners' faces/comments in it
- Rubric based marking (required per spec section 5.4) specifically on mobile, rubric tables tend to be wide and can get pretty awkward on a small screen if nobody thinks about it ahead of time

Where actual testing stands right now

None of this has actually been tested yet, all of it is based on reading the spec plus Moodle docs and other people's write ups, not hands on testing, since we still don't have sandbox access. So treat this whole document as a checklist to work through once we do get access, not as confirmed findings. If I had to pick where to start once we're in, I'd go for the sequencing/edge case stuff and the peer review anonymity settings first since those hit learners directly, then do a wider sweep across the browser list after that.

Sources I used

OAPA Moodle Platform Development Brief V1.2 (client spec doc)
 Moodle Docs, browser support and release notes (docs.moodle.org)
 UNSW Staff Teaching Gateway, Moodle system requirements page
 MoodleCloud knowledge base, minimum system requirements
 LCU Moodle help page, recommended browsers and settings
 SkillSet support portal, browser and device compatibility for Moodle
 a few Moodle.org forum threads on browser compatibility across different versions